



PREPARED BY BOSS KEY LLC

PREPARED FOR

Marc Cunningham and Crawford & Company
growth, proposal, and operational
stakeholders

PREPARED ON

March 20, 2026

PROPOSAL OPERATIONS MODERNIZATION FRAMEWORK

A practical path to stronger proposal operations at Crawford.

For Marc Cunningham's team, the question is not whether automation matters. It is whether the operating chain feeding proposal work is strong enough to support it. Boss Key helps tighten qualification, capture thinking, pricing support, handoffs, review discipline, and knowledge governance so stronger drafts can be built from stronger inputs.

CORE ARGUMENT

Most proposal organizations try to automate weak inputs. Boss Key helps teams strengthen the full growth-to-proposal chain so reusable content becomes more trustworthy, executive reviews become less reactive, and automation can be applied with greater confidence.

WHERE PRESSURE USUALLY SHOWS UP

Qualification drift, compressed handoffs, reactive pricing support, executive review thrash, and content libraries that are technically reusable but not consistently trustworthy.

WHAT THIS EFFORT WOULD CHANGE

A clearer operating model, more trustworthy reusable knowledge objects, and a safer basis for selective automation where the inputs are strong enough to hold up.

WHY BOSS KEY IS RELEVANT

Grounded operating perspective shaped by Broadspire-era content-system work and later cross-functional proposal operations design across growth, proposal, pricing, and review environments.

Why this matters to Marc Cunningham's team

This framework is written around a common operating problem in complex proposal organizations: proposal work becomes compressed and harder to trust when the upstream chain is weak. The issue is rarely a shortage of text. It is a shortage of structured decisions, accountable source content, and repeatable cross-functional rhythm.

Reduce operating drag

Proposal teams perform better when qualification happens earlier, intake is cleaner, pricing enters with enough time, and review checkpoints are defined before drafting gets urgent.

Improve content trustworthiness

Automation-readiness starts when source content is current, owner-backed, and organized as reusable knowledge objects rather than loosely managed document fragments.

Make automation safer to use

The value is not just faster drafting. It is better drafts, less rework, less executive thrash, and more confidence in what the team is reusing.

WHAT BOSS KEY IS PROPOSING

A practical proposal operations modernization effort that helps strengthen the full chain between qualification, capture thinking, pricing support, sales-to-proposal handoff, review discipline, content governance, and execution.

WHY THE BROADSPIRE CONNECTION MATTERS

It matters as restrained proof of long-standing proposal-system experience, including more than 1,600 proposal library entries built in that environment and a later expansion into proposal operations and cross-functional operating design.

Where proposal automation usually breaks

Common pressure points in comparable organizations

- opportunities enter without enough strategy already defined
- proposal joins after the schedule is already compressed
- pricing support arrives late and turns reactive
- executive reviews become fire drills rather than checkpoints
- content is technically reusable but not fully trustworthy
- teams keep rebuilding because source content is not governed tightly enough

MEASURED CONTRAST

Qvidian-style reuse often centers on document-fragment reuse. Boss Key is proposing operating-model-driven reuse: a content environment where current, buyer-relevant material can be assembled from governed reusable knowledge objects.

Three linked layers

Operating Layer

Qualification criteria, structured intake, role clarity, kickoff discipline, review cadence, and escalation paths.

Knowledge Layer

Content inventory, repository architecture, taxonomy, source-of-truth mapping, proof-point governance, and stale-content controls.

Automation Layer

Retrieval-ready modules, governed repository approach, structured prompts and templates, and human-in-the-loop review.

A low-disruption way to work with Crawford

The recommended path is to start narrow, prove value, and give leadership a clearer fact base for what should be standardized, governed, and selectively automated next.

PHASE 1

Diagnostic

Baseline proposal operations, knowledge governance, and automation-readiness within a bounded scope.

PHASE 2

Operating-Model Design

Define qualification, intake, role clarity, kickoff standards, review cadence, and escalation paths.

PHASE 3

Repository and Governance Build

Design the content-object model, taxonomy, ownership structure, and stale-content controls.

PHASE 4

Automation Enablement Pilot

Test selective automation where content and workflow inputs are already strong enough to support it.

PHASE 5

Stabilization / O&M

Launch the governance cadence, track KPIs, capture lessons learned, and sustain the model so it does not slide back into older habits.

CLIENT PARTICIPATION

Boss Key would need access to a bounded cross-functional stakeholder group, sample materials, and a practical level of working-session participation. The value of the model depends on real owners being visible, not just template creation in isolation.

What Crawford would receive and what would improve

WORKSTREAM	DELIVERABLE	WHY IT MATTERS	BOSS KEY ROLE	CLIENT ROLE
Operating	Qualification and go/no-go framework	Protects proposal capacity and screens weak work earlier.	Design the framework.	Adopt decision gates.
Operating	Structured intake and kickoff package	Improves handoffs into proposal planning.	Design the intake model.	Provide inputs and owners.
Knowledge	Content inventory and trustworthiness assessment	Shows what is reusable, stale, or ownerless.	Classify assets and gaps.	Name business owners.
Knowledge	Repository architecture and taxonomy	Makes retrieval practical and governable.	Design the content-object model.	Approve taxonomy and stewardship.
Automation	Retrieval-ready modules and pilot workflow	Tests automation under governed conditions.	Configure and measure pilot use cases.	Review outputs and scenarios.

CURRENT-STATE PATTERN	FUTURE-STATE PATTERN
Boilerplate reuse from static libraries	Governed reusable content objects tied to owners and recency
Reactive bid response	Earlier qualification and capture discipline before proposal launch
Ad hoc SME outreach	Structured intake, assigned ownership, and planned content requests
Last-minute executive reviews	Predefined checkpoints with clear escalation paths
Automation on bad inputs	Automation on governed inputs with human review

A focused pilot for one business line or pursuit segment

The cleanest starting point for Crawford is a focused proposal-ops diagnostic and automation-readiness pilot in one bounded area. The point is to create practical evidence before any broader rollout.

What the pilot would answer for Marc and team

A good pilot answers five concrete questions at once: can the content be trusted, can the repository be structured for retrieval, are intake and handoffs usable, which automation use cases are feasible now, and do cycle time and quality improve under tighter operating discipline?

Trustworthiness

Which assets are current enough to reuse

Repository

Whether content can become governed knowledge objects

Intake

Whether strategy, pricing, and solution input are usable early enough

Automation

Which tasks are ready now and which should wait

Measured Delta

Cycle-time, quality, and review-burden improvement

RECOMMENDED NEXT CONVERSATION

The best next step is a working session around one bounded area of Crawford's world: a business line, a pursuit segment, or a recurring handoff pattern leadership wants to understand more clearly.

DISCUSSION STANCE

This proposal is intended as a practical framework, not a hard sell. If the fit is real, the output should be a narrow pilot with measurable outcomes rather than a broad transformation discussion.